

AI CODING, DONE LIKE ENGINEERING

Your AI agent isn't the problem. Your workflow is.

I packaged the workflow that actually works for me into one open-source Claude Code skill. Install once, use it in every repo.

THE PROBLEM

Why agents write **slop**

1

They plan before they understand

An eager plan built on assumptions nobody questioned.

2

They build in horizontal layers

Phase 1: database. Phase 2: API. Phase 3: UI. No feedback until the end.

3

They write tests after the code

Tests shaped to fit whatever the code already does.

4

They work in the dumb zone

Past ~100k tokens, reasoning quality drops, whatever the window size.

the fix →

THE WORKFLOW

Day shift plans. Night shift builds.

DAY SHIFT · YOU + AGENT

grill

Agent interviews you, one question at a time, with a recommendation

prd

Destination doc: stories, modules, tests, out of scope

issues

Thin vertical slices with blockers: a kanban DAG

NIGHT SHIFT · AGENTS, AFK

tdd loop

One issue per fresh session: red, green, refactor, commit

review

Fresh context, your standards pushed in. Then you QA.

the rules →

5 RULES IT ENFORCES

Old books. New agents.

01 Grill before you plan

Shared understanding beats a pretty plan.

02 Tracer bullets, not layers

Every task cuts through DB, API and UI and ends in something clickable.

03 Red before green

No code until a failing test proves what "done" means.

04 Clear, don't compact

Small tasks, fresh sessions, stay in the smart zone.

05 Deep modules

You own the interfaces. Agents own the internals.

try it →

FREE AND OPEN SOURCE

Install once. Use it everywhere.

```
> /plugin marketplace add khakpour27/madmattskills  
> /plugin install madmattskills@madmattskills  
# then just say: "grill me on  
# then: /madmattskills grill "your idea"  
lt;your idea  
# then: /madmattskills grill "your idea"  
gt;"
```

github.com/khakpour27/madmattskills

Built on Brooks, Fowler, *The Pragmatic Programmer*, Ousterhout,
and Matt Pocock's *Workflow for AI Coding* workshop.